

Banara vanderbiltii

Palo de ramon

Family (Salicaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

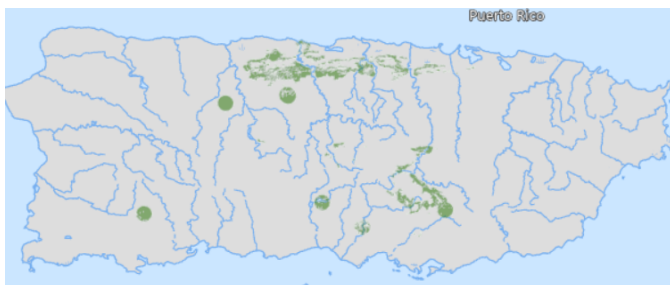
Status (Endangered)

Description

A small evergreen tree that can reach up to 9 m in height. Its young branches and leaf petioles are densely covered with yellowish hairs, and the simple alternate leaves are velvety when young, becoming rough with age. The species produces bisexual yellow flowers with numerous stamens and multi-seeded berries that range from deep red to purple, with a long-pointed style.



Location/Habitat



Found in semi-evergreen forests of the subtropical moist forest zone in Puerto Rico. It is found on the limestone hills of the northwestern coast at elevations of 100–150 meters and in the volcanic mountains of central Puerto Rico above 800 meters. Its habitat includes karst landscapes with steep limestone hills, sinkholes, caves, and well-drained, poorly developed soils, as well as exposed mountainous areas with second-growth forest vegetation.